

levelling-up, badging or other incentivizing systems. In addition, providing sustained and impactful recognition to recognize & retain our contributors. Increase frequency and targeted recognition to types and persona of contributors

DRI: Contributor Success team

Foster Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion

Center diversity, equity, and inclusion within our open source community relations and our wider community of contributors. Reach larger audiences of top contributors and offer more equitable opportunities to contribute.

Align with open source community DEI initiatives

Why: Aligning with open source communities practicing DEI initiatives will offer GitLab more ideas on reaching new contributors and signal our commitment to DEI to potential contributors.

DRI: Developer Relations team & Contributor Success team

Improve contributor inclusion

Why: To improve the contributor experience for newcomers and returning contributors, and meet contributors at different experience levels. We can improve the changes of a contributor returning by creating a more inclusive experience for them.

DRI: Contributor Success team

Expand Outreach

Increase awareness with content and events to drive large amounts of contributors. Our outreach efforts so far have been limited. A proactive and focused effort to bring awareness and drive members from external communities will be required. Engineering to work alongside Developer Relations in expanded outreach events.

Increase contribution backlog exposure

Why: Contributing as a new member to a massive project can be overwhelming, which can lead to analysis paralysis and potentially losing contributors. We should offer a lens into a discoverable, sizable set of issues we can direct newcomers to. Consider using established 3rd party platforms.

DRI: Developer Relations team

Scale contributor events

Why: Build a sense of belonging, provide the social environment for contributors to have their voice, meet with their peers, share knowledge and celebrate.

DRI: Developer Relations team & Contributor Success team

Community office hours & community pairing

Why: We need to scale office hour calls and our community pairing sessions that have traditionally been a unique opportunity for product groups to provide support, guidance to code contributors as well as gather feedback.

DRI: Developer Relations team & Contributor Success team

Increase social presence

Why: Increase our social media presence beyond the currently limited mediums (Twitter, Discord), which will allow us to tap into existing developer communities.

DRI: Developer Relations team

Scale the Community

Leverage the full-time customer contributor model and create wider community teams for sustainable growth.

Returning & Frequent Contributors

Why: Increased contribution by motivating recurring contributions from organizations that use or extend GitLab, such as customers, partners and OSS communities. Reward those that achieve that status with GitLab benefits that are valuable to the individual and the organization.

DRI: Developer Relations team & Contributor Success team

Non-code contributions

Why: Our userbase is made of a lot of different personas who each can make valuable contributions and improve GitLab. Creating design proposals, code reviews, triaging our issues or facilitating healthy discussions between all actors involved helps us achieve our goals faster. In addition, recognizing non-code contributions such as helping GitLab with promoting the product, our events or other ways to contribute should be recognized and celebrated.

DRI: Contributor Success team

Foster more collaboration

Why: We would like to depart from having contributors work single-handedly and create a team that can do more together.

DRI: Contributor Success team

SECTION: engineering/performance-indicators/_index.md

{{% performance-indicators "engineeringfunction" %}}

SECTION: engineering/performance-indicators/maturity.md

Summary

This page contains a table of performance indicators order by their maturity (ascending) so we can understand which ones we need to focus on building. Maturity has to do with the state of the automation, not the metric itself.

Other PI Pages

```
{{% include "includes/performanceindicatorlinks.md" %}}
```

Maturity Legend

```
{{% include "includes/performance-indicator-maturities.md" %}}
```

Performance Indicators by Maturity

<!-- Deprecating as original code is broken as gives all departments

<table>

<tr>

<td>Name</td>

<td>Organization</td>

<td>Maturity</td>

<td>Reason(s)</td>

</tr>

<% performanceindicatorbymaturitylevel.each do |pi| %>

<tr>

<td><%= pi.name %></td>

<td><%= pi.org %></td>

<td><%= colorcodematurity(pimaturitylevel(pi)) %></td>

<td><% pimaturityreasons(pi).each do |reason| %>

<%= reason %>

<% end %></td>

</tr>

<% end %>

<table>

--->

SECTION: engineering/projects/_index.md

```
{{< engineering/projects-table >}}
```

Finding a reviewer

In addition to the lists on this page, the GitLab review workload dashboard provides an interface to find available reviewers and maintainers.

This page is populated automatically as documented in projects.md.

SECTION: engineering/readmes/_index.md

SECTION: engineering/readmes/alexives.md

Motivation for this document

For folks who are currently or planning on working with me, I wrote this as a guide to help you have an idea about how I like to work. I tried to be as honest in here as I could manage.

My role

Really, I just want members of my team to be able to bring their best self, and I want you to feel valued by the organization. I think the best way to pursue that is building trust. My job is to foster trust with the team in all directions. That means:

Advancing an environment where team members feel safe voicing ideas and asking questions and trust that they won't be judged for them.

Building trust between the members of a team, and with me, so that when disagreements happen we all have the empathy to understand each other's positions and move forward.

Bridging trust between the team and leadership so that engineering leadership trusts that we'll execute on their vision, and members trust engineering leadership is pointing the ship in the right direction.

What do I value most?

There are three things I value more than anything else: Trust, Action, and Transparency.

Trust is the basis of leadership, without trust, nothing works. I want you to be able to trust me, and I want to be able to trust you. If I don't, or you don't that's something we have to work to fix.

Action matters. Even if you don't know what to do, saying "I don't know what to do, but let's find out" is an action. Also a valid action: "I'm sorry, but I can't help with that right now due to conflicting priorities, please reach out to Alex if you have questions!" I'm here to back you up, but if something is needed the worst thing we can do is nothing. (In some cases: the action is deciding we're doing nothing, rather than defaulting to it because nobody said anything).

Transparency is a part of trust. If something happens in the dark, it may not have happened. If we can show people what we're doing, and show people what we're thinking, it's easier to establish the trust that we're not doing nothing.

My Expectations

Trust: I trust you to make the best plan and decisions you can with the information you have available to you. I'm not super interested in assigning blame, and if you or someone else make a decision or commit to a timeline that turned out to be the wrong one, the best way forward is just that, forward. If you need help with a plan, I'm here to help.

Do what you say: If you say you're going to do something, and you say when it's going to happen, I trust you to do that. I'm not going to hound or remind you about it. If the circumstances change, I expect you to tell me. If I see the circumstances change, I'll tell you too! This is SUPER NORMAL.

Everybody can contribute: There are two sides of this: If you have an idea or input about something, you can share it. At the same time, if someone comes with an idea, it's our jobs to give it a fair hearing and evaluate it.

Everybody should contribute: If we're having a discussion about a critical topic, I want your input. We want to avoid bike-shedding, but the more people who come in contact with a plan, the more likely I think that plan is to succeed.

Taking time off: I expect you to take time off when you need to. I'm not interested in policing it. I do expect you to find coverage for important issues that need to move forward, and document the status of all of your ongoing work before you go out. My preferred format for this is to file an issue in the team tracker with details about what your ongoing projects are and what should be happening with them.

1:1s

I do 1:1s weekly. I think it's important since we don't all sit together, so it doubles as bonding/trust building time. Primarily, I want you to drive what we talk about in your 1:1 time. That's your time with me to say whatever you want to say!

If you don't have anything to talk about, that's okay! The following are common 1:1 topics:

Let's talk about something you achieved in the last week.

Let's talk through a problem you're having and see if we can solve it.

Planning/discussing your growth: This could be feedback, or we might spend time doing private retrospective kinds of things, or maybe we're making a plan to uplevel your career.

Talking about routine management topics: for example, you're planning to take a big block of PTO, neat!

Talking about cool or interesting things like a delicious new food you tried or how cute your dogs/cats/fish/birds/kids are.

Things I don't want to use 1:1 time for:

Mundane status updates: If something is in progress and that's expected, and you don't have issues or blockers about it, we don't need to talk about it. If you're worried about it, or I'm worried about it, we can raise it! If not, this precious time is better spent on one of the above suggestions.

Venting is okay, but if it's about work I reserve the right to try to build empathy with whatever you're venting about. Also if our 1:1s end up mostly being venting time, we may need to figure that out too!

Quirks

I'm very bad at hiding my feelings. I "Wear my heart on my sleeve" as they say. This often means I tend to be direct. I don't like beating around the bush and if I have a question I ask it (holding it in doesn't work that well for me).

Sometimes I get part way through something, get distracted, and forget to finish

^ If I do this, it's not because I don't care, sometimes my brain checks things off.

Where to focus on your first 90 days?

Build Knowledge: The best way to start contributing is to build up your knowledge about how our systems work, and ask questions! Given the complex nature of our domain, asking questions is actually a form of contribution! If you think something doesn't make sense, there's a chance it actually doesn't make sense.

Make Connections: Collaboration is key, and core, to building good software and systems. Spend time getting to know your peers inside and outside the team.

Ship SOMETHING: I'm not expecting you to ship anything big or complex, but I want to work with you to make sure that you have code in a production code base somewhere in those 90 days.

SECTION: engineering/readmes/amy-shiel.md

Why create a README?

This page is intended to help others understand what it might be like to work with me, especially people who haven't worked with me before.

It's also a well-intentioned effort at building some trust by being intentionally vulnerable, and to share my ideas of a good working relationship to reduce the anxiety of people who might be on my team.

Please feel free to contribute to this page by opening a merge request.

About me

Hi there. My current role is Engineering Manager on the Switchboard Team. We are part of the Dedicated Group in Infrastructure. I am based in Wexford, Ireland. I studied Computer Science & Software Engineering at Maynooth University and spent the next decade as a back-end developer. I then moved into Engineering Management and enjoy empowering engineers to solve difficult problems in a sustainable way. I joined GitLab and the Switchboard team in March 2023. My hobbies include pottery, hanging out with my dog, beekeeping, looking after my chickens, visiting new places and generally being outdoors.

How you can help me

- Feedback

- I love receiving feedback using the Situation - Behavior - Impact Model (SBI) but all feedback is greatly appreciated particularly in relation to async working style. GitLab is my first experience of working in an async fashion and feedback will accelerate my learning

- Inclusion

- I appreciate context sharing and inclusion so please cc me / invite me / @ me where you think I should be included particularly when it involves Switchboard, Dedicated or Infrastructure

My working style

- Direct Communication

- I value direct communication and feedback. I adopt the principle of Short Toes and expect others to provide feedback where appropriate.
- Relator
 - My prominent Gallup Strength is Relator. I enjoy building genuine relationships and working closely with others to achieve outcomes. I am most productive when I understand team members' strengths and can set them up for success.
- Assume Good Intent
 - We are all working together to achieve outcomes and I assume that each team member does the best they can with the skills and information they have at the time.
- Technical Knowledge & Understanding
 - As an engineer that moved into Engineering Management I constantly try to identify how much technical knowledge and understanding is necessary for me to empower the team to solve problems. Sometimes I struggle with this balance. My goal is always to empower the team to grow and solve problems while simultaneously providing guide-rails to keep them on the right track.

Related pages

LinkedIn

GitLab

SECTION: engineering/readmes/andras-horvath.md

{{% include-readme username="andrashorvath" trim=1 %}}

<style>

```
connect-with-me + p > a > img {
  margin-left: 20px !important;
  height: 25px !important;
}
```

</style>

SECTION: engineering/readmes/ben-king.md

Ben's README

This README is designed to give you a bit of background information on me.

Related links

- GitLab profile

About me

Hi! I started with GitLab in December, 2021 as a Support Engineer for the APAC region. I live near Sydney, Australia ·· and my primary operating hours are 8 AM to 4 PM (Australian

Eastern).

Coffee Chat topics

If you're reading this, you might be trying to find things we can talk about for a coffee chat or 1:1.

Here's a bunch of topics I'll be happy to talk about:

Games

- · Board Games. My favourites at the moment are Catan, Ticket to Ride and Pandemic.
- · Video Games. I'm a fan of RPG and/or Strategy games, like Surviving Mars, the Fallout series), and usually anything made by Obsidian Entertainment.
- · Tabletop Games. I have an ever-expanding collection of TTRPG books, including GURPS, Traveller (Mongoose 2nd Edition), D&D 5th Edition, Cyberpunk 2020 & Red, Shadowrun and the Fallout TTRPG.

Books

Favourites include:

- Foundation Trilogy by Isaac Asimov, and the entire Robot series.
- Mars Trilogy by Kim Stanley Robinson
- Hyperion Cantos by Dan Simmons.

Places

These are some places I've visited that I am always keen to talk about:

- Pittsburgh, Pennsylvania, USA
- Shanghai, China
- Blue Mountains, NSW, Australia)

My working style

I like to work from the early A.M. (my time) which overlaps with part of the AMER region. If you are in AMER, we should chat in your afternoon!

I have a tendency to "dive-in" head first into a ticket, even if I am not sure how it will be resolved. I like to learn as I go as hands-on is the best way for me to develop skills. If you want to pair, we should aim for tickets that we might both be unfamiliar with.

How to communicate

I keep Slack and Email open all-day, so I encourage you to reach out to me with whatever suits you for async communication. If we have too much back-and-forth via messaging we should switch to a Zoom call to speed things up.

Weaknesses

I come from a bare-metal, server hosting industry. This means a lot of my experience comes from investigating physical hardware and networking faults. With this, my application-layer knowledge is still developing, especially when it comes to high-availability, kubernetes, databases, and external cloud providers.

Strengths

I have experience with a variety of networking concepts, particularly lower levels of the OSI model. When in doubt, remember: It was DNS. I enjoy the idea of "Self-Hosting" so I use docker to run a variety of services at home, running things like NextCloud, Pi-Hole and of course GitLab!

WFH Setup

Item	Brand
Web Camera	Logitech C920 HD PRO WEBCAM
Microphone	Audio-Technica AT2005USB
Chair	AK Racing K7
Monitor	Kogan 34" 144Hz Ultrawide
Headphones	Sony Noise Cancelling WH1000XM4

SECTION: engineering/readmes/chris-kaburu.md

Chris Kaburu's README

Here you'll get a glimpse of who I am and how I work. You wanna chat, got some questions, a brainwave, or just fancy a chinwag, don't hesitate to ping me. Let's share stories!

A Little About Me ·

I am Chris, hailing from Nairobi, Kenya (a city with a National Park in it). Raised amidst Nairobi's dynamic culture and natural beauty, I developed a love for exploration, continuous learning, and the celebration of diversity, which has inspired my adventurous move to the Netherlands. For me, life is about cherishing little joys and infusing them into our daily work and passions.

My Professional Journey ·

I embarked on my GitLab journey in September 2022 as a Support Engineer. Over time I realized that support is not only about problem-solving, but also about empathy, effective communication, and going the extra mile to make someone else's day better, traits that have been consistent accross my diverse experiences prior to this.

While the allure of working on numerous areas is tempting, I focus on my strengths and rely on the expertise of my colleagues in areas where I'm still learning. My current interests include Kubernetes, Geo, and Performance in distributed systems. I'm dedicated to learning and improving each day, as I explore and discover these technologies and many more!

My Assumptions ·

I was captivated to GitLab Values, and now as part of the team, I've had the pleasure to experience and live by these values. Now, I hold the following assumptions about my colleagues:

- You mean well
- You'll fulfill your commitments.
- You're direct.

Hold me accountable whenever I fall short of these values. I pledge to do the same for you.

How I Work ·

I adhere to a strict work schedule from 6 am to 3 pm CEST, which is when I'm most productive and responsive. Post 3 pm, my response might be slower, and I generally reserve this time for @mentions on slack. Occasionally, I may adjust my schedule based on specific needs or projects.

Availability and Communication Preferences ·

My approach to communication is straightforward: be direct, be respectful, and be open. I believe that clear communication is the key to resolving most problems and achieving effective teamwork. If there's something you'd like to discuss, ask, or need help with, please feel free to reach out. "I'll either assist directly or direct you to someone who can help. I am always game for a coffee chat! Conversations over a good brew are among my favourite ways to connect here with colleagues, to discuss ideas, or just have a pleasant, casual chat.

SECTION: engineering/readmes/craig-miskell.md

{{% include-readme username="cmiskell" trim=2 %}}

SECTION: engineering/readmes/david-wainaina.md

David Wainaina README

A Little About Me

My name is David Wainaina. I joined GitLab on 16 March 2020. I live about 30 minutes away from Nairobi town and about 10 minutes near the airport. In my free time, I love playing guitar, sometimes going to the gym, and swimming.

My Professional Journey

I started my career as a developer/MIS support engineer in a large African telecommunication company. I then transitioned to database administration (Oracle DBA) for 2 years, managing mobile money databases. I then moved to work remotely as a support engineer from 2015 until I joined GitLab.

How I Work

I am usually available from 9 am to 6 pm Kenya time (EAT). I am usually near my laptop after that time and might delay responding to any queries.

You can always reach me via the following channels.

- supportself-managed
- sptpodimportandintegrate
- sptpoddatabase
- Kenya

Availability and Communication Preferences

Feel free to reach out if you need to discuss anything, ask questions, or seek assistance. I'm here to help or guide you to the right person. I love open and direct communication, as it helps us resolve questions easily. Please ping me directly or mention me (@dwainaina) in any public channel for urgent chats.

SECTION: engineering/readmes/eduardo-bonet.md

How I work

I am classified as a Virtuoso according the personality types, and I feel it matches pretty well my style.

I am a generalist: in the past, I've worked professionally as an Android Developer, Fullstack Developer, Data Scientist, Machine learning engineer and at GitLab as Incubation Engineer for MLOps.

I enjoy organizing events to get people together, like the AI Learning Group, or simply going to a pub. In the past I organized multiple meetups.

I am also a member of the Dutch Workers Council.

What to expect from me

- It is difficult for me to focus on a single task or a single group scope. I tend to be attracted solve problems across teams, and be working at 5-6 different things at the same time
- I get a lot of energy of kickstarting and building new ideas
- I get a lot of energy from customer conversations

Strengths

- Torchbearer: I am good at defining a vision for a new idea or product and creating the foundation to to achieve that idea
- Flexible: I can work on the role that is most important for the project to be completed
- I can learn new areas and dive into a codebase pretty quickly. It takes me little time to

onboard in new areas.

- I am very independent (perhaps too independent)

Potential issues

- I can be quite blunt sometimes, even rude sometimes, specially on days where I have a lot in my mind.
- I am difficult to manage, first because it's difficult for me to focus on a single area, but also because I tend to be skeptical
- I tend to drift away or lose interest of initiatives once I sense there's too many people already
- Titles and hierarchy are irrelevant to me, which can cause some friction
- I sometimes lack attention to finer details towards the completion of a task or project (i am better at building the 0-90% than then 90-100%)

SECTION: engineering/readmes/emily-chang.md

Emily Chang's README

Emily Chang - Support Engineer (APAC) This page is intended to help others understand what it might be like to work with me, especially people who haven't worked with me before.

It's also a well-intentioned effort at building some trust by being intentionally vulnerable, and to share my ideas of a good working relationship to reduce the anxiety of people who might be on my team.

Please feel free to contribute to this page by opening a merge request.

· Related pages

- My GitLab profile: @emchang
- Slack handle: @emchang
- My Curriculum Vitae
- Feel free to schedule a · chat with me via Calendly

· About me

I go by the name "Em" or "Emily" and I live 20 minutes away from the bustling city of Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia. I'm very fond of travelling, I love subway maps and I take pride in using public transportation as much as possible. Lately, I'm trying to pick up drawing with brush pens and am learning the Korean language.

The GitLab value that resonates with me the most is · Collaboration - although it's impossible to know everything, I believe we can always learn from each other!

· How you can help me

- English is not my first language, sometimes I have trouble finding the equivalent English

word, so please bear with me, and seek clarifications if needed. In Malaysia, we follow the British English, so the spelling of some words may differ.

- I agree with Negative feedback is 1-1, my DM is always open to any corrections, please do not feel shy to provide feedback - good or bad. I'm always eager to learn and improve myself.
- I prefer to have a meeting agenda/outline prior to the call so I know roughly what to expect. Not knowing what to expect may sometimes give me stress.

- My working style

- I love asking "Why?" because I prefer to understand the goal and expectations before taking on a task, it's a huge motivation for me if I am aware of the impact.
- I work well with clear instructions and due dates, as it helps me to prioritise my tasks.
- I have an eye for detail, I'm not exactly a perfectionist, but I like to double-check before sending. It bugs me when there is a spelling error/grammatical mistake.

- What I assume about others

- We both want the best, I'm a huge believer in win-win situations, and I'm willing to compromise.
- If something is wrong, you are comfortable to let me know. If no one says anything, I will assume you are okay with it.

- Communicating with me

- My typical working hours is around 9AM GMT+8 (1AM UTC) to 5PM GMT+8 (9AM UTC). I'm okay with meeting outside my working hours but I prefer having late meeting rather than waking up early for one.
- I prefer having meetings on Tuesdays, Wednesdays and Thursdays either in the morning or afternoon, I tend to get a bit sleepy right after lunch so please avoid arranging meetings right after my lunch (I have set lunch times in my Google Calendar).
- I practise Focus Fridays where I typically spend the morning replying to my assigned tickets and work on non-ticket work like learning and writing my Weekly Logs in the afternoon.
- I use GitLab To-Do regularly, feel free to ping me on merge requests (MR) or issues.
- I check my Slack and e-mail throughout my working day. Please note that I have desktop notifications turned off when I'm in a meeting. I have phone notifications turn on for the days I am on-call.
- Slack Channels I visit very often: supportgitlab-com, supportself-managed, supportteam-chat, supportwatercooler, apac, women, allcaps, diversityinclusionandbelonging

- Strengths

- I consider myself as a creative person, I am not afraid to think out of the box.
- I am friendly and am always happy to lend a pair of listening ears. Please drop me a message if you need someone to talk to or there is anything I can assist with.

- Weaknesses

- Sometimes, I can be overly optimistic, thus unrealistic. I tend to look for the bright side of things, but I know that it is also good to be prepared for the worst. Please remind me if you've noticed this and is affecting my work!

· My Remote Work Setup

Item	Brand
-----	-----
Height-adjustable Desk	Flexispot Electric Height Adjustable Standing Desk
Ergonomic Chair	Leap Chair
Headphones	HyperX Cloud Alpha headset
External Monitors	Two 24" Samsung CF390 Curved LED Monitor
Dual Monitor Arm	North Bayou F160
Keyboard	Keychron K2v2
Mouse	Logitech MX Master 3
Laptop Stand	Olmaster Laptop Stand
Webcam	Logitech C920
USB C Hub	Ugreen 10 in 1 USB C Hub

SECTION: engineering/readmes/gabey.md

Gabriel's README

Hello, I am Gabriel, but you can also call me Gabe.

I have many years of experience in application engineering and have used git for most of those years.

I'm also an avid cyclist and music lover. I love to cook and travel as much as possible.

I speak English and Spanish and am currently working on picking up Dutch as well.

Related

[Team page](#)

[Profile](#)

My working style

I'm methodical and I like to ask a lot of questions and follow the data to get a full picture.

Communicating with me

If you need some assistance with issues or MRs, I am happy to help you. Please use @gyoachum to tag me on GitLab.com

For urgent, synchronous communication, you can reach me on slack with @gabe.

E-mails are always fine as well.

Weaknesses

Sometime I let perfect get in the way of good enough.
I have a hard time turning down work.
I am naturally an underconfident person.

Strengths

I work very hard.
I am always looking for ways to be more efficient.
I am very easy to work with and always looking to help my peers.

SECTION: engineering/readmes/jane-gianoutsos.md

Jane G's README

· Everything is in draft - that includes this! I welcome all feedback! You are very welcome to contribute to this page by opening a merge request.

Jane Gianoutsos - Manager, Support Engineering (APAC) This page is intended to help others understand what it might be like to work with me, especially people who haven't worked with me before.

You'll find as you read this I've made a clear decision to be very intentionally vulnerable. Trust is earned, and I hope to offer you in this a basis for why you might trust me, and to share my ideas of a good working relationship to reduce the anxiety of people who might be on my team. Come as you are, I take you as you come and hope you will do the same for me.

About me

I live in Auckland, New Zealand, with my husband, and the pleasure of myriad native New Zealand birds in our neighbourhood.

As a kid I dreamt of working at NASA and as a teenager decided this meant becoming an astrophysicist. An uninspiring physics teacher and a revelation about how many years of study that would take put me off. An inspiring lecturer at university set me on the path of IT, and it feels like home. I love people and their stories and how they've journeyed to where they are and where they'll find themselves in their future. I sometimes ponder doing an anthropology degree.

I'm a serial hobby-ist who loves learning new skills, but once it starts getting expensive (either financially or time-wise) to continue to learn, I tend to move to the next hobby. See the final section if you want to know more!

About transparency

I wear my heart on my sleeve, I'm very honest about what I struggle with, and I struggle to be generous with myself about what I'm good (or great!) at. Meanwhile, I love to encourage others - I'm passionate about the power of words and their impact on us. It's often in encouraging others that I notice I need to pause and take my own advice - thank you for any opportunity for

that!

Sometimes people think my face says things that I'm not intending! If I look focused and overly serious in a concerning way, and you're wondering why, please ask, it's most likely that I'm trying (and failing) to multitask, or I'm wrestling with some insistent thought going through my mind.

About things I'm passionate about

Honoring my opening statement, this is a rough start at expressing my passion for creating and holding space where all people can thrive. I have a dysregulated nervous system and a disability. I am incredibly passionate about neurodiversity and identity and accessibility and belonging. I welcome chatting and learning together.

About working together

- What's going on in your life doesn't stop just because you're at work. Please don't feel you can't talk about something because it's 'not work related'. Life is messy, let's work together to make it a little easier.
- I deeply respect your dignity and I count it a privilege that I get to do a little bit of life with you.
- I'm very at ease with emotion, I don't attach shame to tears, some things just need that release, it's incredibly healthy and part of being fully human.
- I'm here to help - I won't always have the answers and I don't expect myself to (just as I don't expect that of you), but even if it feels off-topic, please reach out.

What I assume about others

- honesty - I'll take you at your word
- a desire to contribute
- positive intent
- you've got more going on than I know about or than you perhaps realise yourself

You can assume the same about me in all instances.

About Communicating with me

- I'm usually online around 9:30am NZT, but I tend to avoid meetings for the first 30 minutes to give me time to be a bit more human and clear out overnight messages. I am still available at this time.
- For my mental well-being, I seek to finish work by 6pm local time (NZT) to give myself time for family and relaxation. Sometimes this isn't possible due to on-call responsibilities which finish at 8pm or 9pm depending on time of year, but I limit my work activity to those oncall needs after 6pm on those days.
- I don't like being expected to read between the lines, and I don't expect you to either. Please be as open and direct as you feel comfortable being and if you're struggling with that, let me know and we can work it out together.

As promised above!

More about hobbies

Recent hobbies have included:

- speedpuzzling! I had no idea how much I'd enjoy this. I'm actually not very fast but I love it anyway.
- needlefelting fanciful forest critters (no photos yet)
- calligraphy,
- book-binding,
- zentangle.
- boardgames!
- Dr Who
- Star Trek
- Reading - fairly eclectic taste, but for escapism: sci-fi and a bit of fantasy

Further back hobbies included crochet, sewing, New Zealand Sign Language (sadly I've forgotten most of what I learnt), photography, fermented foods (sauerkraut, sourdough bread, kombucha, kefir water, pickles), water color painting, acrylic painting,

A long while ago I did a series of blog posts on getting comfortable with using Open Office Write and a bit of OO Calc.

Way back hobbies included horse-riding, singing, playing guitar, Hamilton Community Gospel Choir, softball, Girl Guides (yep, that far back!)

SECTION: engineering/readmes/juan-silva.md

Juan Silva @ GitLab

(a.k.a my Manager README Doc)

I am looking forward to meeting you in person or virtually, but in the meantime, here is me in a nutshell. I hope this introduction helps to give you a sense of where I come from, how I think and what it is like to work with me.

I hope direct reports, peers and managers will find this content equally useful. But since everyone can contribute, feel free to submit a MR if you find anything to be inaccurate or ping me if there is something else you would like me to add here.

A bit about me

I am originally from Mexico. I came to Canada in 2007 with my family to study at OttawaU, and we decided to stay. I know what you are thinking, a bit of a weird migration pattern for me going north weather-wise, but we genuinely love Canada, and we are delighted raising our daughters here.

You can read about my professional career history [here](#).

I am an introvert, and I have been told by long time friends that they thought I was angry when they met me for the first time. I can have a stern expression, but I am friendly, I promise!. I would be happy to hear about your life if you want to share it with me, but I don't expect anyone to do so.

I am also a very analytical person. I love to explore ideas and listen to other people's opinions. Still, I will also constantly challenge assumptions seeking for a better outcome (even my own thoughts). If this happens, please don't think it is personal; I was raised by a father that always encouraged critical thinking and debate between my siblings and me.

I value commitment and pride in doing good work. I am driven by constant learning and have an affinity for others who are too. I always have a positive can-do attitude until I am proven wrong. I always encourage team effort, constructive criticism and open-mindedness in my team.

Learn more

- [LinkedIn](#)
- [GitLab Team Profile](#)
- [GitLab User](#)
- [Twitter](#)

My role

I joined the GitLab team as Fullstack Engineering Manager, Geo. In this capacity, I am primarily responsible for the well-being and performance of the Geo Team members. For this, I draw from my strong technical background and my previous experience managing high performance teams to provide an environment of psychological safety where best ideas win and everyone can contribute.

I firmly believe that the best way to lead is to help people do their jobs in the best way they can. No one knows better how to do your job than you do. I am here for you whether you need to bounce off ideas, get advice, remove blockers or just chat about technology trends. I want you to advance and develop professionally as well, so you can be in a better position to help GitLab and the Geo product move forward too.

Communication

To me, communication is vital. I will make it a priority to keep team members informed about strategic plans and objectives, so they can do their job with the necessary context. I will also spread the word about what my team is working on and engage in collaboration with other teams to make sure we feed on each other's progress.

Chat Anytime

I am also open to talking at any time. You can ping me any time, either through synchronous tools like Slack or asynchronously via email or commenting in issues and MRs. I am always happy to start a Zoom call when we need to expedite our conversation and make decisions quicker.

Meetings

In terms of meetings, I like blocking time in my calendar to do my own tasks, so feel free to book me anywhere you see a spot open.

My preference is to have back to back meetings and not have small slots of times in-between. I always provide an agenda for the meeting, and I encourage you to always do the same.

1-1

If you are a member of my team, we will have plenty of opportunities to discuss work and anything else. I like to have semi-structured 1-1's regularly (probably as often as weekly at the beginning). This is your time, and we can discuss any matters that are important to you. We keep a standing shared agenda doc where you can add your topics in advanced. The structured part will include filling out a simple PPP template, which can be done asynchronously before coming to the meeting.

During 1-1's you are more than welcome to share with me about your personal life if you choose to do so. I will share too from time to time. I think it is important to have a sense of what is going on with each other's lives as context for how we conduct ourselves and make decisions at work. Of course, this is optional and it will be up to each individual to decide if and when they want to share. I am good either way :)

Email / Slack

I am on Slack online throughout my work day. I am usually pretty responsive or let you know if I need to get back to you later. If topics are relevant to the rest of the team, I rather chat in public channels to provide that context for others.

In terms of email communications, I usually have two times where I read and reply. First, early in the morning before I start my day, and then in the mid-afternoon.

You can send me Emails or Slack messages any time (day or night), I will get back to you as soon as possible. You may also receive some messages from me off-hours (in your time zone), but I don't expect you to reply at those times.

Collaboration

Whether you are my peer, my manager or a member of my team, you should know that I really enjoy working with others. I think collaboration almost always leads to better outcomes, and I have found this to be specially true when solving interdisciplinary problems or those that have a high degree of technical uncertainty.

I always welcome requests for me to provide feedback and I am ready to offer my opinion. As my own workload permits, I will also be happy to participate more hands-on on your project or task.

Coaching and Mentoring

I love learning, and I also love to teach. I find something gratifying in helping someone else

to acquire a new skill or advance their professional development.

I generally try to adapt to your learning style. Some people only require general advice and minimal direction. Others would prefer a formal learning path that includes specific learning milestones and materials (i.e. books, tutorials, courses, etc.). I am happy to do either.

> "Train people well enough so they can leave, treat them well enough, so they don't want to" - Richard Branson

My objective is to help you grow so you can advance in your job and have a bigger impact at GitLab and beyond.

Work / Life Balance

This is to give you a sense of how I manage my personal work/life balance and not convey any expectations from you.

I am a morning person, and I like to get a head start before the 'regular' business hours. I typically keep an eye on Slack and emails throughout the rest of the evening after the end of day and may reply right away if I am not watching Netflix ;)

I often do some work on weekends. Sometimes because I have to, and some times because I am working on something fun and I can't wait until Monday to pick it up again. If not doing something directly work-related, I at least spend some time with a toy project teaching myself something new.

Sometimes I lose track of how long it's been since I took a day-off, and I have to remind myself to do so. However, I do enjoy vacation time, mostly when travelling, and disconnect from work and come back with recharged energy. I do expect you to take sufficient time off, and I will remind you from time to time if I see you have not done so.

My expectations

I expect to spend a great deal of time observing and learning before offering my opinions unless directly asked sooner. Please don't mistake my initial silence with a lack of interest or attention.

I expect to learn a lot from team members who have more subject matter knowledge or context than me.

I expect my team members to work with autonomy and with my trust (no micro-management) while keeping me informed of progress and any possible risks and/or blockers.

I expect my team to communicate openly and collaborate closely in order to achieve goals and overcome the challenges ahead of us.

Some trivia facts about me

- Learned scuba diving when I was 5 years old
- Started programming in Basic at the same age

- Hardly ever eat fruit even though I do like it
- Played for Mexico's National Waterpolo Team (yes such team exists)
- I thought myself how to juggle watching youtube videos
- Travelled to 22 countries within a single year
- Lost count of how many times I have watched all episodes of Friends

SECTION: engineering/readmes/kamil-trzcinski.md

Introduction

My name is Kamil Trzcinski and I am a Senior Distinguished Engineer as part of the Memory team,
and I live in Poland.

I joined GitLab in 2015, June. I contributed to GitLab a way before me joining the company. My most notable contribution was GitLab Runner at the beginning of 2015, which got me hired into GitLab in the first place.

I decided to write the GitLab Runner, because I wanted to learn Go. The GitLab Runner is my first actual project written in this language. Go was ideal choice for it due static compilation (easy to distribute), great support for Docker and very efficient execution model (able to concurrently execute many jobs at once). Additionally, I always loved simplicity of Drone.io. I used a number of ideas and implemented them in a initial version of GitLab Runner, allowing it to heavily use Docker.

Links

GitLab.com account
dev.gitlab.org account
ops.gitlab.net account
Team page

What I do focus

My primary focus is a work related to Memory team and a work related to CI/CD space. I take an active part in a number of discussions related to the above topics, because I'm simply interested in a topic and think that I can provide a useful feedback.

My usual day

I start my work around 10 am (CEST/CET time) with a breakfast and a first cup of coffee. Sometimes it is 9:45, sometimes 10:30.

I spend my morning mostly looking over TODOs, MRs and check what did happen since the yesterday.

This is also time when I have coffee chats with other people, but I usually prefer these

to start around 11 am.

During the day, I mostly tend to concentrate on my personal work. I'm also usually available for random interruptions from the team or peers on topics that they need extra pair of eyes. I have a lunch around 1pm-2pm.

Afternoon is usually occupied with meetings. During that period I rarely look at MRs/TODOs, and rather spend time on meetings or contribute to discussions on issues or merge requests.

I finish my day between 5pm and 8pm, depending on a day, and how focused I'm on getting something done.

It is common for me to be on a Slack till late hours, but this is not indicative of me working, rather indicative of me being in front of computer and doing some other stuff, like watching movies, or working on a hobby projects.

In general I aim to work on average 7.5hr per-day (with lunch), but this varies between days.

Work style

I have a strong tendency working on many topics at the same time as I always have many different ideas that I'm passionate about.

Working on many topics at the same time is sometimes challenging due to context switching, but I usually do not find it very tiresome. These are reason why I like doing that:

Broaden the knowledge

- I'm genuinely interested in a topic

- I want to learn new technology or new area

- I want to try different ideas and see how complex they could be if implemented

- I want to explore a potential improvement to a known problem

- I want to research an issue that I saw

- I see it as a potential improvement to the product

My way of speeding up learning process is creating a Proof of Concept.

I do it for a various reasons:

- I tend to create many Proof of Concepts to check different approaches

- I timebox time spend on Proof of Concept, dismiss the Proof of Concept if it takes too long as too complex

- I use Proof of Concept to get a quick validation of the idea

- I use Proof of Concept to understand the complexity of the implementation and potential problems with the approach

- The Proof of Concept is not perfect, it is never meant to cover all cases, nor meant to be merged

- The Proof of Concept does showcase one of the solutions to the stated problem

- The Proof of Concept can be used to validate the performance characteristic of the approach

- I describe Proof of Concept with the assumptions and limitations around which they got created

The Proof of Concept can be a good discussion point that allows to further decide if the approach is correct, and what are needed steps to get it into mergeable state

I like working on many merge requests at a single time. I tend to aggressively split my work into a very small mergeable chunks, and merge them early. It is common to me to have a work divided into 4-5 MRs that depend on each other and create some sort of chain. To help with constant rebases I do use my script rebase-all that does all heavy duty work.

My expectations

In everything that I do (myself or when reviewing someone else changes) I always aim to slightly improve the code around the given change. My idea is that spending 10-20% more time on resolving technical debt does allow us to constantly refactor the codebase without doing refactors specifically. My perception about scheduling refactors is that this is usually a bad idea. I find it much easier to constantly refactor the codebase while working on a new features. I do expect from anyone working with me: do a little more than it is described to make our live easier in the future.

A few examples how I approach above:

- comment something that I discovered, but was not obvious
- improve architecture of existing implementation
- rewrite methods and tests to make them easier to read or make them more performant
- create issues about problem discovered
- do a small merge request prior to this change to improve some aspects

My focus

While doing my work or looking over someone else work I usually care most about:

- security (always at the first place): in particular I look at all authentication and authorization code, and try to ensure that a well established patterns are used instead of reinventing a wheel
- data structure: that database structure is future-proof: I consider that data migration is the hardest thing to do at a scale
- performance of the solution: I in particular look at mis-use and edge cases that might affect execution time (CPU/DB time or Memory usage)
- usage limits: defines a upper usage limits to which the solution is tested, define limits that prevent mis-use of the solution
- extensibility: that solution is extendable in the future
- style: that it is implemented coherently to existing code, and it have a proper structure (OOM)

Outside of purely implementation aspects I do also care about:

- it is user-loveable UX: it is clean, and coherent with existing feature

Work Environment

I work always from home. I don't really like working from co-working spaces. I find my chair and big desk to be a deal breaker for me.

I'm big fan of the virtualisation. I try to virtualise all my systems and seamlessly switch between them using the same keyboard, mouse, and monitor. I automate as much as possible of my work and my environment. This is why I have a 4x4 keyboard to control all aspects of my work environment. This is connected to ESP8266, which sends commands over MQTT to Home Assistant, the Home Assistant later controls all my lighting, PCs/Macs, Monitors and Speakers and switches and turns on or suspends them if needed.

As for the system that I use. I do have tendency on changing constantly my working system: for most time I work on Mac, but also used Desktop Linux for over 3 years. I even had a short episode (around week) trying out Windows.

Recently, I do all my GitLab related work in Visual Studio Code, which connects to my Ubuntu VM virtualised on PC. I do all my work remotely, using Mac only as a good looking desktop. I maintain my own GitLab Compose Kit to have a fully immutable development environment. I use it exclusively for last 3 years.

I do not store any of keys on a disks. I use Yubikeys to authenticate everywhere. I have a Yubikey for each computer that I use.

SECTION: engineering/readmes/katrin-leinweber.md

Katrin's README

Hi, I am Katrin! Biochemist by training, but IT generalist by choice. Having used Git in its various forms since 2014, I'm keen diving deeper into the GitLab-surrounding technologies and applications.

Related

[Team page](#)

[Profile](#)

[Calendly page to schedule a chat with me](#)

My working style

I tend to jump in quickly upon recognizing a task I can complete, going into sleuthing-around-logs-and-code mode when necessary.

Communicating with me

I enjoy working asynchronously via issues and MRs.

Particularly also with GitLab's To Do function.
Please use @katrinleinweber liberally.

For urgent, synchronous communication, I'm fine with Slack or Zoom,
but please be sure it is really urgent.

E-mails are not a good choice, as I check them only rarely,
some times not even once a week.

Weaknesses

Too little stepping-back-and-seeing-the-big picture,
when working on urgent tasks.
Good ideas sometimes come to me only after a good night's sleep.

Strengths

Good ideas come to me usually after a good night's sleep,
or a walk through the great outdoors.

Because I worked in different industries and contexts,
I think I can rely on a broad base of experiences
and problem-solving approaches.

SECTION: engineering/readmes/lee-matos.md

+ As your manager, my goal is to find the intersection of what you want and what the department needs. I am always open to ideas and helping to carve out time for you to accomplish things you find important.

+ By nature, I end up being "the manager I want to have." I need to be more of the manager you want to have. Help me fulfill that by giving me feedback, and I'll do what I can to make those changes.

+ We'll host weekly 1-1s. This is your time to help me help you achieve what you want. Bring topics and ideas and I'll happily help to scope them out so we can accomplish them. I'll expect you to have your 1:1 doc ready before our meeting, and to lead that meeting.

+ I aim to provide actionable constructive feedback weekly during our 1:1's. If you feel like you have a specific question or need clarity, feel free to ask!

+ My calendar is always open for team members. This is a great way to make sure you have my attention. Absolutely schedule some time with me and I will be there to talk about anything you want my ear for.

+ If you find me slow to respond or you need something urgently, you can ping me multiple times. I will not take offense.

+ I prefer slack based communication, so you will probably have your best results linking me to the thing you need me to comment on in slack.

+ You'll often find me around at "weird times", this is because I'm managing a global team and I want to be available. I do not expect this of team members and if I ping you back at an "odd hour" it's okay to wait until normal work time to respond.

+ I as a person do not enjoy vacation. You are not me. GitLab has a generous vacation policy and if you want to take time off, get it on the calendar, communicate it to the team, and I support it.

+ In the spirit of being transparent, here is my 2018 360 Feedback (GitLab Internal only) in it's entirety.

(Inspired by <https://mattnewkirk.com/2017/09/20/share-your-manager-readme/>)

SECTION: engineering/readmes/lyle-kozloff.md

My Job

My job is to clear obstacles, set context, and build process. In general: to make your (work) life easier, clearer and less stressful.

More, I have the privilege of helping you get better at things. I do this by helping you set goals, providing feedback and acting as a voice of accountability.

My Availability

Precious few things are more important than talking to you if you want to talk to me. If you need to talk, let's talk. I'm here to enable your success - use me for that.

I snooze my Slack notifications when I'm not available. If you think of something at 2 a.m. it's 100% okay to send me a message. I expect that you will also control your notifications.

Nothing on my calendar is urgent unless specifically noted as such.

Communication preferences

1. GitLab: I'm very responsive on GitLab issues when pinged, and have notifications turned on for most trackers

in gitlab-com/support.

1. Slack: I prefer Slack for most short interactions and questions. Avoid private messages when you can.

1. Zoom: As noted above, I'm always available for a video call.

1. Email: Email is my notification channel. I've sent less than 500 emails and received more than 40,000 in the 2+ years between Jan 2018 and Feb 2020. Nearly all of those emails were to people outside of GitLab.

1. Phone: I have a phone, but often reject or screen calls from unknown numbers. This isn't the

best way to get in touch.

Notification Priorities

1. GitLab To Do items - if you need me, @lyle me!
 1. MRs - Don't block others work
 1. @mentions - Don't block others work
 1. Other items
1. Email Uncategorized - unknown risk and priority for categorizing trends
1. Calendar invites - affects availability
1. Support Team Meta - be aware of what's going on in the team
1. General notifications from GitLab (subscribed issues and such)

Other meetings

I'm open to ad-hoc meetings with anyone who wants to chat - whether you're in my department but report to someone else, or in a totally different department.

My Assumptions

- You're good at your job
- You know the team priorities and how they fit in with your personal priorities
- You will ask for help if you need it
- You feel safe pushing back
- We'll tell each other if there's something we could have done better

Greatest Strengths / Greatest Weaknesses

I'm a collaborative leader and accept input readily. At its best, this means you'll feel empowered. At its worst it means that you'll feel like I don't have a vision for what I want.

- What to do if it's the worst: Tell me that you're not clear on my expectations and that my apparent indecision is blocking progress.

I reprioritize constantly. At its best, this means that important and impactful things get done quickly. At its worst, it means that I miss a deliverable that you were waiting on from me.

- What to do if it's the worst: Give me a firm deadline for when you need something by. Check in on progress. I don't mind being managed up; if what I'm prioritizing doesn't match your priorities I should be able to articulate what's blocking me.

I operate my teams with a high degree of trust: At its best, this means that you are free to prioritize the tasks that you feel are the most impactful. At its worst this means you may feel like I don't care what you're working on.

- What to do if it's the worst: Generally, I will only step in if you can't find a solution, you need my help or you've hit a blocker. Keep me informed, and be clear if you're in one of the above states.

I try and protect my teams from crappy work by doing it myself: At its best, you'll be shielded from the small, annoying tasks that crop up. At its worst, I'll be drowning in these tasks and I'll ask you to do something that's (at best) half-done and probably overdue.

- What to do if it's the worst: If I'm setting myself up as a blocker, call me on it. I try and build process after I have a full understanding of the problem set, but sometimes I need a nudge before I feel its ready to hand off. Sometimes I misjudge the complexity or length of a task.

Your development

>

> From the time you were very little, you've had people who have smiled you into smiling, people who have talked you into talking, sung you into singing, loved you into loving.
>
> Fred Rogers

One of the best ways to learn is to have excellence modeled and to copy it. Therefore:

- Continue pairing after your onboarding is over.
- Attend crush sessions; ask questions.
- Choose topics, seek out experts and relentlessly pursue them.

I want to help you grow. I can / will / have:

- play the role of your conscience and ask you annoying questions about your progress
- be a "study buddy" and grow/learn together
- help you find projects that require you to learn in a certain area
- cheer you on and broadcast your successes

Your development as a leader

One of the most important pieces of my job is to help you grow as a leader. Some of you may be people leaders, some of you may lead as individual contributors - but your ability to influence decisions will be a determining factor you in your immediate and future success. I will do my best to lend strength to your voice, and help your ideas find their way into results.

Feedback

As with most managers, feedback is an area that I never feel like I give enough of. If you're looking for feedback and I'm not offering it, it means I think that you're doing just fine.

I do look for opportunities to compliment wins, but I miss things. If you're proud of something, please bring it up!

If you're not getting feedback and you want some, please ask for feedback in a specific area:

- "I'm not feeling confident about topic X, can you take a look at my work Y this week and let me know how I did?"
- "This week I did X, even though we talked about doing Y, because of Z. Did I prioritize correctly?"
- "Was this response clear?"
- "Should I be spending more time on X, or Y?"

This will help me give clear, timely feedback that will make a difference instead of a bumbling "You're doing great!"

Behaviours I value

- Initiative: you see a problem, formulate a solution and act on it, asking for input if only when necessary
- Humility: you do excellent work which draws attention to itself
- Consistency: you do what you say you'll do most (if not all) of the time
- Vulnerability: if you don't know, you ask (and in so doing, create an atmosphere where it's okay to not know and ask)

Feedback for me

Like you, I rely on feedback to improve. If you feel there is something I could do better, please tell me! If I get salty, defensive or react negatively: call me on it.

If you don't feel comfortable addressing this with me directly, please tell my boss.

1<>1 Meetings

This is your meeting and your time: you set the agenda and determine what we talk about. My most effective 1:1s have an agenda that builds up through the week, but I've had some really great free-form ones as well. Don't feel bad if you don't come with something prepared.

If we don't have anything on the agenda, please expect me to try and get to know you better.

If you're struggling for topics, please include items that you've worked on this week.

I like hearing about situations in your week because:

- I always learn something
- I get data points that help me make global process improvements
- I get a picture of what things you're great at
- I begin to understand which things you struggle with

Don't save urgent matters for a 1-1

Strength of Feeling Scale

Sometimes I'll express an opinion with a strength qualifier. The scale is 1-10.

1 - Strongly opposed

5 - True Neutral

10 - Strongly for

Confusingly, I may be strongly for a negative. For example: "No, I'm like a 9 against that." Strictly following my own system, I should say "2"... but I think it's more easily understood phrased like that.

Other

- My expectations are sometimes expressed softly. If there is any doubt about whether something I say is an expectation, a suggestion or an idea please ask.
- Please feel free to correct me in public channels if I'm wrong about something. I appreciate opportunities to model humility and my commitment to being a life-long learner.

SECTION: engineering/readmes/marin-jankovski.md

Purpose

Inspired by the CEO page,
this page is a readme for the Marin Jankovski.

Team(s)

Over the course of my tenure at GitLab, I've bootstrapped and onboarded a number of teams. Currently serving in the role of a Director of Platform Infrastructure.

I was a team lead and an engineering manager for Distribution team, Delivery team, and Scalability team

I was the first engineer working on tasks related to GitLab installation and as GitLab grew, so did the need to impact wider scope increase.

As I build a team, the first task I tackle is to ensure that my teams have a clear mission and vision. The handbook page for each team is the single source of truth for that team, and if the information is not discoverable on the team page, it can be considered as not important.

Time allocation

Between enabling every team member to do their jobs the best they can, engineering tasks and hiring, my work day is a stream of context switching.

To ensure that I can stay on top of my tasks, I use bullet journaling combined with my Remarkable2 tablet. I finish each day by writing the list of tasks that need to be completed the next day. I start each work day by cross checking my weekly and monthly plan with the daily list I created the day before to prioritise the order of tasks I am aiming to complete on that day.

This ensures that I do the highest priority items on the short term, while aligning with the mid to long term set of tasks. This approach also allows me to question whether the long term

plan is good for the current state of affairs.

1-1s

I hold weekly 1-1s with all my direct reports, and monthly 1-1s with all my indirect reports.

Most common call duration is 30 minutes

but this vastly depends on the individual report. In all cases, I find it acceptable when the meetings are both shorter and longer, but I dislike skipping these calls.

I've found that important information gets lost when 1-1s are skipped because the smallest, most insignificant looking "btw" often can save a lot of time and effort down the line.

I don't often quote other people so I won't do that now too, but I'll just say that High Output Management - Andrew Grove is very often right in my opinion.

My 1-1s do have some structure, but only as a guideline in case people are not inspired (which can often be the case when you have the same type of call every week, or when the calls are far apart).

The structure consists of:

Every meeting has the Google Doc accessible to the direct report and myself only

The doc has a suggested topics template at the top that the report can use if they want to

The doc is filled by the report 1 working day before the meeting

The doc can be used as a place to write down all the thoughts, positive and negative

In case of an item that requires attention prior to the scheduled call, the report can mention me or raise it up in direct message in Slack

My Availability

My calendar is generally blocked during the early morning/evening. I usually do not accept meetings during this period

I have a work only laptop which contains only one non-work related account: music streaming application.

If I am responding during my off hours, that usually means that I am traveling or I have a pretty

big behaviour regression

I do not have Slack or work email setup on my phone so I will not respond to pings unless I am at my work laptop

Communication

I have a very direct communication style, sometimes mistaken with being upset a